

CCD Board Meeting Minutes

4 January 2027

Participants

- Philip Ogston; Larry Lankford; Myra Mitchell; Valerie Allendorf; Darlene Underwood; Charles Wallner; Richard House; Audrey Eyman;
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Itemized Key Topics & Detailed Summaries

1. **Executive Committee — role, transparency, and reporting**

- Discussion centered on clarifying what the Executive Committee handles between full board meetings (editing language for votes, administrative work), how its decisions are reported, and ensuring board awareness of meetings. Plan: announce Exec meetings at least 24 hours ahead, allow board members to listen in, and report outcomes back to the full board. Myra will send agenda announcements/minutes if an Exec meeting occurs before the next board meeting.

2. **Meeting minutes & central document repository**

- Minutes from the prior month were shared; a minor wording fix was noted. The group emphasized moving approved charters and governing docs into a central, organization-owned Google Drive (not personal accounts). Kurt will add a website link for minutes; Myra (with Josh and Kurt) will work on setting up the shared Drive and access model using an official account that can be passed to future secretaries.

3. **Treasurer's report & dance receipts (trend analysis)**

- Larry circulated December spreadsheets; Darlene highlighted monthly receipt trends (strong May; rising Nov–Jan) and requested analysis. Valerie tracks attendance, weather, and “how heard” inputs weekly and will share May data. Philip observed honor-system revenue per dancer appears healthy (~\$5 Monday / ~\$10 Saturday). Larry will prepare a calendar-year report and separate PigTown figures to avoid trend distortion.

4. **New Year's Eve dance debrief**

- ~52–60 attendees; net positive outcome; snack area/potluck format worked well and encouraged community time. Specific payouts: Trillium \$300; Kenny \$100; sound declined payment; +\$100 donation; approx. +\$240 net. Philip trialed a “base snack table” concept (fruit/cheese/sweet) and will personally seed the next few Saturday dances to validate before budgeting.

5. **Committee charter framework & assignments (normalizing operations)**

- Goal: draft clear charters for essential and “nice-to-have” functions; Exec Committee will harmonize language and ensure scopes don’t conflict; board will vote, then call for nominations for leaders.
- Template sections include scope, deliverables/tasks, timeline, budget, resources, reporting. Audrey suggested clarifying “Tasks/Deliverables” semantics in the template; agreed to refine.
- Preliminary assignment highlights:
 - **Opening/Closing crews:** already approved; leaders to be nominated after call.
 - **Scheduler/Talent policy** and **Sound Scheduling:** Philip to coordinate with John McCain on sound charter; payment handling is explicitly *not* in sound scheduler scope (Treasurer handles).
 - **Website coordination:** Kurt (via Valerie) to define tasks and access patterns for publishing minutes and content.
 - **Advertising / Outreach / Retention:** Valerie and Audrey to collaborate; may split into distinct charters (e.g., advertising vs. recruitment & retention).
 - **Waltz Night / Special dances:** Charles to liaise (e.g., with Hildebrandt) and draft a structure that respects existing practice while formalizing board touchpoints.
 - **PigTown Fling:** Valerie (with Larry, Myra, Charles) to draft charter that fits the standardized format.
 - **Regional outreach, honoring volunteers, snack table:** added as “nice-to-have” charters to codify ongoing practices.
 - **CDSS relationship:** Charles to draft a contact/liaison charter; ensure event collateral and insurance/process alignment.

6. **PigTown Fling budgeting & structure (separate tracking)**

- Reinforced that PigTown functions as a fundraiser that helps sustain regular operations; Larry keeps a separate accounting (same bank account; separate reporting). He will share the last two years’ reports. Darlene proposed an analytic “virtual pot” approach for visibility; Audrey noted budget/actuals already tracked and recommended discussing structural changes with PigTown & Finance committees.

7. **Monday after PigTown — caller/band scheduling**

- A Chicago-supported caller (Devin Pohly; recommended by Bob Isaacs) inquired about calling Monday after PigTown; current schedule lists Margaret Ann. Consider etiquette and

budget implications (\$50 left in out-of-town budget for H1), and whether to make the Monday a “PigTown chaser” in future years. Consensus: schedulers (Bonnie & Deven) own talent coordination; board won’t micromanage but appreciates courtesy notices of changes. For future (e.g., 2027), propose formal alignment between PigTown and Monday scheduling. Audrey will initiate an email thread to shape a clear proposal for a later board agenda.

8. **“New Talent Development” policy (local callers/bands & rotation)**

- Clarified that “new talent” can mean (1) developing local talent, (2) introducing outside bands/callers, or (3) adding a caller/band to regular rotation. Concern raised about process (e.g., Jerome added without broad input). Decision: Darlene and Richard will co-draft a charter (or multiple charters) to define pathways and criteria; Charles emphasized historical mission of talent development within contra organizations.

9. **Recruitment & Retention (R&R)**

- Audrey is building a welcoming/retention effort and seeking additional volunteers; plan to write a charter and attract a leader once the charter is approved. Coordination with advertising will be considered.

10. **Venue logistics (lighting, space use, comfort)**

- Ideas to define “scene modes” for lighting (e.g., mood shifts per set) and ensure comfortable hangout zones (basement during winter; porch in summer). The New Year’s Eve setup validated basement hangout value; temperature balance noted (basement was hot after boiler service).

Key Decisions (explicit or consensus)

- **Exec Committee reporting cadence:** If an Exec meeting occurs before the next board meeting, **Myra will send an agenda announcement, and minutes afterward**; board members can listen in (non-voting).
- **Document management:** Move to **central, organization-owned** Google Drive and website link for minutes (Kurt to configure; Myra/Josh/Kurt to structure access).
- **Charter process:** Continue drafting charters using the shared template; Exec Committee will harmonize and bring them to the board for vote; only then call for nominations and elect leaders.
- **PigTown accounting:** Maintain **separate PigTown reporting** (not a separate bank account) and share historical reports; PigTown serves as the organization’s financial engine.

- **Schedulers' autonomy (near-term): Bonnie & Deven** may adjust Monday-after-PigTown scheduling if talent agrees; board requests courtesy updates; broader structural change (e.g., formal "chaser") should be proposed and voted in advance (likely for 2027).
 - **New talent development: Darlene & Richard** will draft definitions/processes (could become multiple charters) before the board sets policy.
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Action Items (owner → deliverable / due where applicable)

- **Myra** → Announce any upcoming Executive Committee meeting (≥24 hours notice) and distribute minutes afterward.
- **Philip** →
 - Write and circulate the **call for nominations** for Opening/Closing crew leaders; provide a stage layout / job description for transparency.
 - Share temporary links for draft/approved charter documents; coordinate sound scheduling charter with **John McCain** (scope; non-payment handling).
 - Continue **Saturday snack table seed** (fruit/cheese/sweet) as a donation pilot; report results for possible budgeting.
- **Kurt (via Valerie), Myra, Josh** → Stand up the **central Google Drive** (org-managed account); configure **website minutes link**; define access controls.
- **Larry** →
 - Produce **calendar-year financial report** (with PigTown separated).
 - **Send PigTown 2-year reports** to the board.
 - Covered sound for Zoe (COVID) and continues coordinating with John McCain as needed.
- **Valerie** →
 - **Draft PigTown charter** (with Larry, Myra, Charles) and **Advertising** charter; continue email marketing cadence; share **May attendance/weather** dataset with Darlene & Richard for trend exploration.
 - **Coordinate with schedulers** (Bonnie & Deven) and Margaret Ann re: **Monday-after-PigTown** inquiry (Devin Pohly); politely respond based on feasibility and budget.
- **Audrey** →
 - Co-develop **Advertising vs. Recruitment & Retention** scope split; propose naming and charter language.
 - Start **email chain** (Darlene, Charles, Valerie, Myra, Richard, Bonnie & Deven) to frame a **2027 Monday-after-PigTown proposal** for a future board agenda.
- **Charles** →
 - Draft **CDSS liaison/contacts** charter (insurance, flyer presence, regional partner relations).

- Draft **Everybody's Dance** and **WFAC coordination** charters that respect existing governance while defining CCD touchpoints.
 - **Darlene & Richard** → Co-draft **New Talent Development** charter(s): criteria & process for adding local/out-of-town talent and entering rotation.
 - **John McCain** (with Philip/Larry) → Provide input to **Sound Scheduling** charter: scheduling workflow, on-call swaps, payment separation.
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Open Questions / Items to Bring Back Next Board Meeting

- Final wording fixes in prior **meeting minutes** and confirmation of central repo location.
- First set of **new charters** ready for vote (which ones will be prioritized next month).
- **PigTown Monday 2026**: outcome of scheduler/talent conversations and budget feasibility; any courtesy update to the board.
- **New Talent Development** proposal: are there 1–3 distinct charters; draft language and criteria.